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Chapter 1

defensive

1.1 overcall

1.1.1 simple

When unfavorable (or V, by judgement), we'll overcall sounder (the "traditional": either good suit with strong LD value, or 11+).

```
# if PH or partner PH, can be lighter but requires shape or lead-  
    directing  
# if balancing against pre, may be lighter  
# for upper limit, see t/o  
1X = 8+, 5+X  
1N = (14)15-18, usually promises stopper.  
2X = 10+, 6+X; 12+, 5+X.  
3X = (13)14+, 6+X; 15+, 5+X  
jump 3Y against 2X pre = 16-18, good 6+Y
```

1.1.2 unusual

1.1.3 high level

```
(4m) - 4N = nat.  
(4M) - 4N = minors or some 5-5.  
(1m) - 3m = nat. (unless 1D = unbal)  
(1M) - 3M = Western cuebid. ask stop
```

1.1.4 balancing

system ON for now

1.1.5 sandwich

```
(1X) - P - (1Y) -
1N = nat
2X = nat (Rubens from 2Y)
2Y = nat (no Rubens)
after X or overcall: Y is the cuebid suit

(1X) - (2X) - 2N = unusual
(1X) - (1N) - X = t/o to X
```

1.2 t/o

```
minimum take out at 1-level:
4333: 13+
4432: 11+, 43+M or 4+oM
1-card opp's suit: 10+ outside
0-card opp's suit: 9+ outside

at 2-level: +2
at 3-level: +4
may be slightly sounder if adv will likely need to bid 1-level higher.

# style: slightly emphasizes major
```

1.2.1 uncompleted or low-level

```
(1Y) - X -
1Z = 0-8(9), natural length # free bid: 4+ with shape, or 6+
    raise: constr, roughly 15-18
2X = 0-8(9), natural length
jump 2Z = 8-9, 5+Z; or (9)10-11, 4+Z
jump 3X = (8)9, 5+X; or 10-11(12), 4+X
double jump = inv with shape and some strength # not pre!
1N = 8-10(11)
2N = (11)12-13

# after 1X - X
[X = m] cue = any GF; or 44+M inv
    2M = 4+M. raise is the only NF bid
        new suit = usually 5-cards except 2S after 2H
    2D/2N+ = nat and GF. basically shows 16+. # since non-GF must have
    4M.
[X = M] cue = any GF
```

```
[X = m] jump cue = 54+M, good shape, mixed-raise-ish
[X = M] jump cue = Western cuebid (?)
```

After $2X - (X)$, see [Lebonsohl](#).

1.2.2 interfered

```
(1m) - X - (XX) - P = pen.
(1M) - X - (XX) - P = pick a suit
```

```
# if re-doubled:
(1m) - X - (XX) - P = pen.
(1M) - X - (XX) - P = pick a suit

# if natrual overcalled:
(1X) - X - (1M) - # TODO: 2M ?
    X = constr+, 4+M
    2M = cuebid # therefore 3M = Western, 2C/3C = nat 8-/9-11
otherwise X = responsive

# if transfer overcalled: basically
(1X) - X - (transfer 1M) -
    X = responsive
    1M = 4+M, NF # note: therefore forcing with 4+H need to P first?
    others = same
otherwise X/cue = responsive emphasizing strength/shape
```

1.2.3 X then rebid

```
# here min means X then bid's min
non-jump rebid at...
    1-level: 16-19, 5+X
    2-level: 16-19, 5+X
    3-level: 16-19, 6+X; 18-20, 5+X
cue = stronger than above
jump / double jump = similar range (can be slightly higher) but 6+X and
    Loser oriented
raise to 2-level = 15-18
```

1.2.4 high level t/o style

We use double very "elasticly":

- at 4H+, tend to show a strong bal with good defensive tricks

- however, may also be hands that promises transferable strength, allowing partner to bid with good shape. An example is `-.AQJxx.Axxx.KTxx`. With stronger values, you will bid 4N for t/o.
- X to 4H tend to be more t/o-ish, compare to X to 4S+

1.3 advances

1.3.1 NT overcall

system ON for now, but *maybe Gladiator later*.

1.3.2 Basic Rubens: simple overcall non-competed

We use Rubens' advances after a simple overcall to an 1-level suit opening lower than or equal to 2D. We first discussed the case where no interference, including X. The rule is: transfer from opp's suit (skipping 2N), until 2X or 3X (direct raise).

```
(1X) - 1Y - (P)
1N = 9-11(12) nat NF, may be lighter (trying to correct contract) if
    short. sounder if partner PH.
2N = (12)13-14(15), nat inv NF
1Z = F1. usually 5 but may be 4.
2W < 2X = nat, F1, 10+
    then cue = extra, other under 2Y = nat and not promising extra
    raise = min fit
jump 2Z = weak.
jump cue = mixed raise
jump 3-suit = (12)13-14, nat 6+suit inv # fit-showing if PH
transfer from 2X (opp's suit): 10+ (12+ promises rebid); or 8+ with 6+
    suit (can be weaker if longer)
    transfer accepted = not max (13-)
    raise = (12)13-14 with fit
    new suit = F1
    rebid = not min
    others = nat
    # transfer than back to 2X = 10-13 NF, exactly 2-fit
    # transfer than back to 3X = GF, exactly 2-fit
    # transfer than 2N = same as direct 2N, but with side suit
transfer to 2Y = inv+ fit
```

```
(1Y) - 2X - (P)
2N = nat inv NF # roughly same strength as inv against opening
2W < 2Y = nat, F1, 10+ or 8+ with 6+ suit
    then cue = extra, other under 2Y = nat and not promising extra
```

```

    raise = min fit
jump 3-suit = (12)13-14, nat 6+suit inv # fit-showing if PH
transfer from 2X (opp's suit): 10+ (GF promises rebid)
    transfer accepted = min # if X: still ON, P shows slight extra and
    perhaps don't like this suit
    rebid = mild extra but NF # no space here ...
    others = nat and GF
    # transfer than back to 3X = GF, exactly 2-fit
transfer to 3Y = inv+ fit

```

1.3.3 simple overcall doubled

- XX = lead-directing (Hx or Hxx)
- if we overcall 1X, then transfer from 1N instead. transfer to opp's suit = 10+ no good shape
- if we overcall 2X, then 2N = some art raise (see [the 2N raise](#))
- others = same

1.3.4 simple overcall interfered

the general rule is:

- X = Responsive. but if they use some transfer, then X = LDX and cue = responsive
- P then X is still t/o (responsive)
- if mixed raise unavailable, then 2N = some art raise (see [1X_interfered/the 2N raise](#))
- if direct cuebid still exists, then Rubens ON
- all bids become competitive and NF instead, only promises a weak-2 hand.
- others = same. i.e. jump is still invitational (of fit-showing)

1.3.5 misc

a "free" 2N rebid of a 2m overcaller is unusual (usually 6+m and 4+om)

1.4 vs 1N

We choose the widely-used multi-Landy, and also consistent with our opening preempt. For responses, see [pre](#).

```
X = at least opp's mid-range
2C = 10+, 54+M; or 8+, 55+M
2D = 6.5-Losers or 10+, some 6+M # stronger hands can 2D then bid 3M
2M = 10+, some 5M4m; or 8+, some 5M5m
2N = nat 55m wide in range
3m = nat. vs strong: wide in range, comp; vs weak: very constructive
    (13-15), inv 3N
3M = nat pre
3N = Gambling 3NT
```

```
(1N) - 2C - (P/X) -
    XX = I have own long suit (not C)
    P = s/o in C
    2N = s/o in D # no specific reasons
    2D = ask 5M, then 2N/3m/3M = NF inv
    3m = nat GF
    3M = constr
```

1.5 vs high level pre